

~~# Politi~~

PSIR

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①

"Real is Rational & Rational is Real"
— Hegel.

Importance of statement :-

— The statements represents Hegels :-

- i) Ontology — conception of Reality.
- ii) Epistemology — theory of knowledge
- iii) Metaphysics — spiritual aspects of Nature
- iv) Politics —

Context of the statement :-

— Critic of Immanuel Kant.

1. Kant is also a German Philosopher and both Hegel & Kant consider as Great Philosopher.

Kant was so great Philosopher that he was known as "Prince" among Philosopher.

Kant is known as Quintessential Enlightenment

Thinker. it means the best thinker to spread the Enlightenment.

Enlightenment was a Intellectual movement.

↓
to be understood
with reference to the
Medieval Ages.

Quintessential
means true representation
of Enlightenment.

Medieval Ages in the west are known as Dark Ages.

↳ Eclipse on Reason due to Religion.

Religion is a age of Faith / Superstitions.

Superstitions means fear of ^{super}Natural.

How we can liberate ourself from the fear of Super Natural ? -

- By knowledge of science.

Science -

- its a true knowledge. True knowledge means which is verifiable.

What does Enlightenment Represent ? -

- Believe in the Reason of Man. / Believe in the capacity of man to Unravel the Mysteries of Universe. — This will lead to the development of Science.

Enlightenment represent revival of Reason which led to the development of Science.

Science promoted Empiricism → it means knowledge based on observation / Experience.

②
• Empiricist tradition developed in U.K & lead to Utilitarianism whereas, in Germany deontological theory developed.

Means of Experience :-

- We gain Experience / observation through our Sensory Organ.

In modern time in west we see 2 Philosophical tradition :-

i) Utilitarian — became prominent primarily in U.K.

Utilitarianism is based on Empiricism, it means it based on Experience.

ii) Rationalism — became prominent in Germany. they gave primacy to Reason over Empiricism / Experience.

iii) Romanticism — French tradition like — we can see in Rousseau.
It is metaphysical, it means we find Reflection of God in Nature.

⇒ Hegel combined all these 3 traditions.

NOTE :- Hegel combines all the 3 traditions into integrated systems of thought.

NOTE :- In Indian Context,

- Aurobindo Ghosh also integrates different systems of Philosophy.

Hence, Aurobindo is called as Great Synthesiser.

Not only he combines Empiricism, Rationalism & Romanticism, he also combines Eastern & Western Tradition & he was very influenced by Hegel.

Views of I. Kant :-

- Quintessential Enlightenment Philosopher

↳ Revives Rationalist Tradition.

Hence, he does not take Religion as the basis to define the principles of Morality / Ethics. to be found in Reason of Man & not in Religion.

Why he does not accept the authority of Religious books ?-

- Because he believes that there is a limit to Human Reasoning.

He categorises the universe into 2 aspects:-

i) World of Noumena / World of God. - man

does not have capacity to understand the world of Noumena. Hence, there is no basis to accept the authority of Religion.

Religion = Church, Priest.

ii) World of Phenomena / World of Humans -

- He believes that we have capacity to understand the world of Phenomena.

What should be the basis of Ethics ? - (a/c to Kant) :-

a) Religion

b) Reason (✓)

c) Experience

(4)

• Study of Kant & study of Buddha is almost same (Kant)

• He suggest that Communist ~~and~~ does not believe in God where Liberalist believe in God.

• Kant divides Universe into 2 aspects:-

i) World of Noumena

ii) World of Phenomena

→ it is world of God.

→ it is world of Human.

Why Religion should not be the basis ? -

- Nothing can be said about the world of God with certainty.

Why Empiricism can not be the Right basis ? -

- Because Experiences of people vary

Hence, for Kant Ethics has to be Universal in Nature.

What will be the basis to derive Universal Principles ? -

- Human Reasoning.

Why ? -

- Because every human is Rational. Since, Every human is Rational, Everyone deserves to be treated with dignity.

The First ultimate principle of Ethics. is called as Categorical Imperative.

↳ it means to be followed under all conditions. it means it is Absolute Duty

What does De-ontological Ethics denote ? -

The term Deontology comes from the Greek word "De-onton" which means Duty.

Universal principles which should be applicable to all.

• Indian word for Duty is "Dharma"

"Real is Rational & Rational is Real"
— Hegel.

Context of this Statement!—

- i) He questioned Kant's view who held that there is a limit to Human Reasoning. Man can only understand the world of Phenomena and not the world of Noumena.
- ii) However, for Hegel there is nothing beyond Human Reasoning. Hence, whatever is Real is Rational. It means Man has capacity even to understand the God.
- iii) There is a political purpose of Hegel behind such statement. He wanted to show that state is a Reflection of God on this Earth. It means the way we obey the God, in similar manner we should obey state.
- iv) Hegel suggest that we can understand God by —
- a) Reason
 - b) By Observation / Experience.
- v) Hegel establishes that God is absolute idea. For Hegel idea is the Ultimate Reality. Hence, Hegel is idealist. However, his idealism differs from Plato. For Plato only idea is Real & the world of Matter is a world of illusion i.e. shadow of Reality.

v) Hegels idealism comes near to Aristotle.

For Aristotle both Idea and Matter are Real and inter-dependent.

Hegel also take the concept of Teleology from Aristotle.

Hegel applies the concept of Teleology in his Philosophy of History.

The Teleological view of History suggest that history moves a/c to a definite Plan in a definite direction.

For. e.g. :- Aristotle explains Teleology through Potentiality and Actuality.

* "Rational is Real." *

- it means "State is a march of God on 'Earth.'"

Here, Rational means God / Idea / Spirit / Geist.

i) Rational means God. God means :-

a) Absolute Idea — perfect state.

b) Universal Spirit — something which is common in all things of this world.

Why he uses the term Spirit? —

- The term spirit denotes motion / Evolution. it means that we can understand more and more God by understanding the process of Human Evolution.

↳ it means Human History.

What is Human History ? —

— History is a movement of Idea/ God/ Spirit.

Which type of Movement ? —

— Dialectical Movement.

What does dialectical movement denotes ? —

a) Unity of opposites — it means Idea and matter exist in all the things of this world.

⇒ So long opposites exist, motion exist. it means spirit will keep on developing.

b) Negation of Negation — it means Negativity or lesser truth will keep on getting eliminated. it means matter will keep on getting eliminated & spirit will keep on becoming more & more.

Hence, in Every next stage of Human Evolution, we can see greater proportion of spirit.

For. e.g. ! — There is more spirit and less matter in living things than in Non-living.

The maximum amount of spirit is in state.

c) Quantity changes into Quality ! —

— when only spirit remains & matters gets eliminated completely. This happens in the formation of state.

↳ it is a stage when Mind/ Idea/ Consciousness/ spirit/ Ghost/ Truth become fully Conscious of its existence.

We can understand State, representing God by looking at the functions performed by the state.

The Functions of State & God is similar i.e. Universal Attribism.

State is God can be understood —

a) by Observation.

b) by application of Reason.

State is the end point of Human History, it means there will be no more evolution beyond state.

Why? —

— Because, in the State Dialectic Ends / the End of Contradiction.

Contradiction b/w Man & Man Ends.

We all become the parts of Universal spirit.

⇒ By obeying the laws made by State, we are obeying God. we are obeying our true spirit.

What is Freedom For Hegel? —

— Freedom is obedience to law.

Why? —

— Because it is obedience to our true selves.

* Such view of freedom is called Moral Freedom.

Moral Freedom is obedience. Obedience means duty.

Real Freedom lies in performance of ones duty.

Q) What is Gandhi's conception of Freedom / Swaraj?
- It means controlling one's passions / desires...
 & performing one's duty.

In the words of Gandhi,

"Rights are Inherent in the Duties Performed"

↳ this is called as Moral Conception of Rights.
Some conception is found in Aurobindo Ghosh.
^{Gandhi's & Ghosh's}
~~Ghosh's~~ concept of duty & Rights comes from "Gesta."
Outcome of Gesta is "do your" Duty."